

▷ Phrygian cap, a symbol of the revolution



1789

## FRENCH REVOLUTION

In June 1789, representatives of the Third Estate (the French people) declared themselves a National Assembly, vowing in a tennis court at Versailles to establish a written constitution.

When a mob stormed the Bastille prison (a symbol of the king's tyranny) on 14 July, the government was forced to agree to the abolition of the aristocracy. The day marked the end of the Ancien Régime, France's centuries-old political and social system.



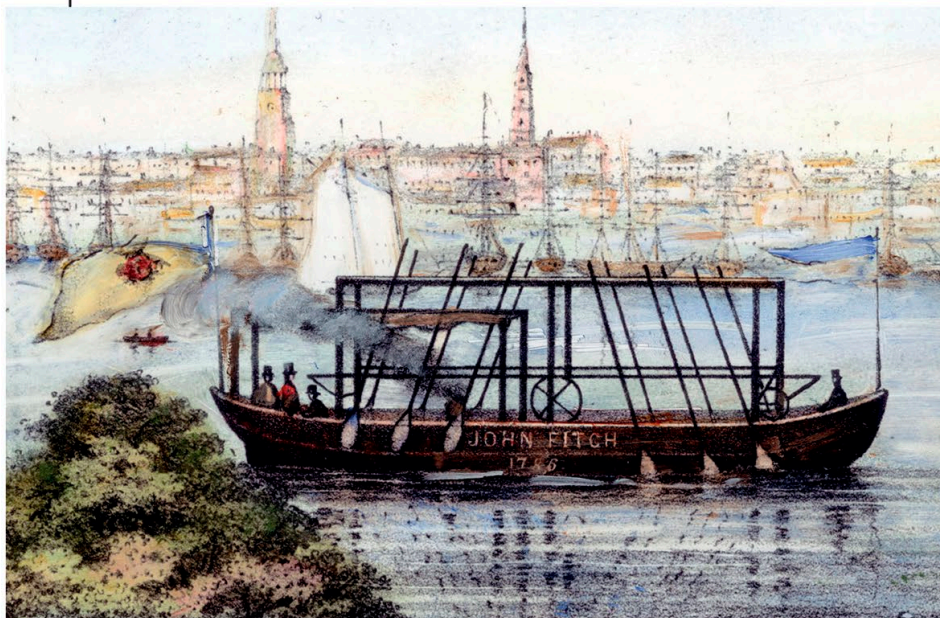
△ *The Tennis Court Oath*, Auguste Couder

1789

**1788 Hungary revolts against** the Holy Roman Empire

**1788 The first colonists arrive in Australia:** they include 732 convicts and 22 children

**1789 Revolutionaries in France issue** the *Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen*



△ John Fitch's vessel sails the Delaware River

1787

## FIRST STEAMBOAT ON AMERICA'S RIVERS

On 22 August 1787, American inventor and engineer John Fitch made the first successful trial run of his steamboat *Perseverance* on the Delaware River. He went on to establish the first regular steamboat service in US history, laying the foundations for the great age of steamboat travel on America's rivers.